Notes version: 11 Nov 13:51 IST (if this time is old, reload the page)

HISTORY · The Revolt of 1857: causes, course, impact

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? In **May 1857** the Company's Indian soldiers (**sepoys**) at **Meerut** rose in revolt, marched to **Delhi** and declared the old Mughal emperor **Bahadur Shah II** their leader. Within weeks, **soldiers, dispossessed rulers, landlords, peasants and artisans** in north and central India joined. It was the **biggest challenge** the Company ever faced. It **failed by 1858–59**, but it **ended Company rule** and changed how Britain governed India. Learn it as **Causes (why) → Course and centres (how it spread) → Why it failed → What kind of revolt was it → Results**.

1. Causes

Causes of the Revolt

Area	Causes
Politics	**Doctrine of Lapse** (Satara, Jhansi, Nagpur); **Awadh annexed (1856)** for 'misgovernment', the home of many sepoys; **Bahadur Shah's successors** told they would lose the **imperial title** and the **Red Fort**; **Nana Saheb** (adopted son of the last Peshwa Baji Rao II) denied his **pension**; Indian rulers and nobles lost **status and jobs**.
Economy	**Very high land revenue** and sale of land for arrears; **taluqdars of Awadh** lost villages under the **summary settlement (1856)**; **artisans and weavers ruined** by British goods; **Inam Commission (1852)** took away rent-free lands in the Deccan; Indians kept out of **high-paid posts**.
Society	British **racial arrogance**; fear that **Western education, railways and telegraph** would break caste and custom; laws on **sati (1829)** and **widow remarriage (1856)** seen as interference.
Religion	**Missionary activity**; the **Religious Disabilities Act (1850)** let a convert to Christianity **inherit ancestral property**; rumours that the British wanted to **convert** Indians.
Military	**Low pay**, no promotion beyond **subedar**; **General Service Enlistment Act (1856)**: new recruits had to serve **overseas** (crossing the sea was taboo for many); **foreign service allowance (batta)** stopped; loss of **free postage** (1854); a **high ratio of Indian to British troops** (about 5:1) gave confidence.
Immediate cause	The new **Enfield rifle**: its **cartridges** had to be **bitten** before loading and were said to be **greased with cow and pig fat**, offending both **Hindus and Muslims**.

2. Course and centres

- **29 March 1857: Mangal Pandey** of the **34th Native Infantry** attacked his officers at **Barrackpore** (Bengal); he was **hanged on 8 April** and the regiment disbanded.

- **10 May 1857:** at **Meerut**, sepoys freed comrades jailed for refusing the cartridges, killed officers and marched to **Delhi**; on **11 May** they proclaimed **Bahadur Shah II** Emperor of Hindustan. The British retook Delhi in **September 1857** (John **Nicholson** killed); **Hodson** captured the emperor, who was **exiled to Rangoon** (died 1862).

Main centres and leaders

Centre	Indian leaders	British officers and outcome
Delhi	Bahadur Shah II; General **Bakht Khan** (real military leader)	Nicholson, Hodson; retaken September 1857
Kanpur	**Nana Saheb**, **Tantia Tope**, Azimullah Khan	Havelock retook it (July 1857); **Colin Campbell** beat Tantia Tope (Dec 1857); Tantia Tope **captured and executed (April 1859)**
Lucknow (Awadh)	**Begum Hazrat Mahal** (for her son **Birjis Qadr**); **Maulvi Ahmadullah** of Faizabad	Siege of the Residency; **Henry Lawrence** killed; relieved by Havelock and Outram, then **Colin Campbell**; retaken March 1858
Jhansi	**Rani Lakshmibai** (her adopted son was denied the throne under Lapse)	**Hugh Rose** took Jhansi (April 1858); she joined Tantia Tope, took **Gwalior**, and **died fighting in June 1858**
Bihar (Jagdishpur)	**Kunwar Singh**, an elderly zamindar	William Taylor, Vincent Eyre; he died in April 1858
Others	**Khan Bahadur Khan** (Bareilly), **Liaqat Ali** (Allahabad); in the **Hyderabad State**, **Turrebaz Khan** and **Maulvi Allauddin** attacked the **British Residency (17 July 1857)**	The attack failed; Diwan **Salar Jung I** kept the **Nizam** loyal to the British; the **Madras Presidency**, including the Telugu districts, saw **little armed rising**

3. Why the Revolt failed

- **Limited spread:** the **south**, **Punjab**, **Sindh**, **Rajputana** and most of **Bengal** stayed largely quiet; **Sikhs and Gurkhas** fought for the British.
- **Princes and the educated class stayed away: Scindia, Holkar, the Nizam**, the rulers of **Patiala and Kashmir** helped the British (Canning called them **'breakwaters to the storm'**); the **English-educated middle class** did not join.
- **No common plan, leader or programme:** leaders fought **for local aims**; there was **no unified command** and **no idea of the future** India they wanted.
- **British strength: modern weapons**, **telegraph** and **railways** for fast news and troop movement, **naval control**, money, and able commanders.

4. Nature of the Revolt: views

View	Who
'First War of Indian Independence'	**V.D. Savarkar**, in 'The Indian War of Independence, 1857' (1909)
'A wholly unpatriotic and selfish sepoy mutiny'	**Sir John Seeley** (British historian)
'Neither the first, nor national, nor a war of independence'	**R.C. Majumdar**
Began as a mutiny, became a revolt with wide support (official centenary history 'Eighteen Fifty-Seven', 1957)	**S.N. Sen**
A Muslim conspiracy using Hindu grievances	**James Outram**

5. Results

- **End of Company rule:** the **Government of India Act, 1858** and the **Queen's Proclamation (1 November 1858)** (Day 15); the **Mughal dynasty** and the **Peshwa title** ended.
- **Policy changes: no more annexations**, princes made **allies**; **army reorganised** (more British troops, artillery only with Europeans, 'martial races'); **divide and rule**; more **caution about social reform**; the **Indian Councils Act 1861** began to include a few Indians.
- **Legacy:** the Revolt became a **symbol of resistance** that inspired later nationalists.

EXAM TRAP

29 Mar 1857 Mangal Pandey, Barrackpore; **10 May** Meerut; **11 May** Delhi, Bahadur Shah II; **Sept 1857** Delhi retaken; **Kanpur**: Nana Saheb, Tantia Tope (executed Apr 1859); **Lucknow**: Begum Hazrat Mahal; **Jhansi**: Rani Lakshmibai (died June 1858, Hugh Rose); **Bihar**: Kunwar Singh; **Hyderabad**: Turrebaz Khan (17 July 1857); **Canning** Governor-General; immediate cause: **Enfield rifle**; **General Service Enlistment Act 1856**; views: **Savarkar** (war of independence), **Majumdar**, **S.N. Sen**, **Seeley**.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the Revolt of 1857:
1. Mangal Pandey attacked his officers at Barrackpore in March 1857.
2. The sepoys at Meerut rose on 10 May 1857.
3. The rebels proclaimed Bahadur Shah II Emperor of Hindustan at Delhi.
4. The Revolt spread widely across Punjab and the Madras Presidency.
Which of the above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 1, 2 and 3 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: B. Punjab and the Madras Presidency stayed largely quiet; Sikh troops even helped the British.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (centre) with List-II (leader):
List-I: A. Kanpur B. Lucknow C. Jhansi D. Jagdishpur
List-II: 1. Kunwar Singh 2. Rani Lakshmibai 3. Begum Hazrat Mahal 4. Nana Saheb

A. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

B. A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1

C. A-4, B-3, C-2, D-1

D. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2

Answer: C. Kanpur: Nana Saheb; Lucknow: Begum Hazrat Mahal; Jhansi: Rani Lakshmibai; Jagdishpur: Kunwar Singh.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following pairs (British officer : role in 1857) is NOT correctly matched?

A. Hugh Rose : capture of Jhansi

B. John Nicholson : recapture of Delhi

C. Colin Campbell : relief of Lucknow

D. Henry Havelock : capture of Bahadur Shah II

Answer: D. Bahadur Shah II was captured by William Hodson.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): The greased cartridges of the Enfield rifle became the immediate cause of the Revolt.
Reason (R): The sepoys believed the cartridges, which had to be bitten, were greased with cow and pig fat, offending both Hindus and Muslims.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. R explains why the cartridges triggered the revolt among both communities.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (historian or writer) with List-II (view of 1857):
List-I: A. V.D. Savarkar B. R.C. Majumdar C. S.N. Sen D. John Seeley
List-II: 1. Neither the first, nor national, nor a war of independence 2. Official centenary history 'Eighteen Fifty-Seven' 3. A wholly unpatriotic and selfish sepoy mutiny 4. First War of Indian Independence

A. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3

B. A-4, B-1, C-2, D-3

C. A-1, B-4, C-2, D-3

D. A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2

Answer: B. Savarkar: war of independence; Majumdar: neither first nor national; Sen: centenary history; Seeley: selfish sepoy mutiny.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the causes under Politics, Economy, Society, Religion, Military and the immediate cause. 2. Write the centres with Indian leaders and British officers, with dates. 3. Write the reasons for failure, the four views and the results.

POLITY · Constitutional bodies: Election Commission, UPSC and APPSC, CAG, Finance Commission and others

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? A **constitutional body** is created **directly by an Article of the Constitution**, so Parliament **cannot abolish it by an ordinary law**. (A **statutory body** like the NHRC is made by an Act of Parliament; an **executive body** like NITI Aayog by a government order.) These bodies do jobs that must stay **neutral and independent** of the party in power: **conducting elections** (Election Commission), **recruiting civil servants** on merit (UPSC, APPSC), **checking how public money is spent** (CAG), and **sharing taxes** (Finance Commission). That is why the Constitution gives them **fixed terms, hard removal procedures and protected salaries**. For each body, learn: **Article → appointment → term → removal → functions**.

Constitutional bodies at a glance

1. Election Commission of India (Arts 324–329)

Point	Details
Role	**Superintendence, direction and control** of elections to **Parliament, State Legislatures and the offices of President and Vice-President** (Art 324). Elections to **panchayats and municipalities** are conducted by **State Election Commissions** (Arts 243K, 243ZA).
Composition	**Chief Election Commissioner (CEC)** and as many **Election Commissioners** as the President fixes; **multi-member** since **1993** (CEC + 2). First CEC: **Sukumar Sen**.
Appointment and term	By the **President** on the advice of a **selection committee** (**Prime Minister**, **Leader of the Opposition** in the Lok Sabha and a **Union Cabinet Minister** nominated by the PM) under the **2023 Act**; term **6 years or age 65**.
Removal	**CEC**: only **like a Supreme Court judge** (Parliament's special-majority address). **Other ECs**: by the President **on the CEC's recommendation**.
Other Articles and facts	**Art 325**: one **general electoral roll**, no exclusion by religion, race, caste or sex; **Art 326**: **adult suffrage** (voting age **18**, 61st Amendment 1989); **Art 329**: courts **cannot interfere** during the election process (disputes by **election petition**). The **Model Code of Conduct** is **not a law**; **EVMs** used nationally since **2004**; **NOTA** since **2013**; **VVPAT**; **National Voters' Day: 25 January** (EC founded 25 Jan 1950).

2. Public Service Commissions (Arts 315–323)

Point	UPSC	State PSC (e.g. APPSC)
Appointed by	**President**	**Governor**
Term	**6 years or age 65**	**6 years or age 62**
Removal (Art 317)	Only by the **President**: for **misbehaviour** after a **Supreme Court inquiry**, or for insolvency, paid outside work or infirmity	Also only by the **President** (the Governor can only **suspend** pending the inquiry)
Functions (Art 320)	Conduct **exams for recruitment**; advise on **methods of recruitment, promotions, transfers and disciplinary matters**; its advice is **not binding**; it sends an **annual report** (Art 323), laid before Parliament.	Same for the State services; report to the **Governor**, laid before the State legislature.
History	**Public Service Commission (1926)** on the **Lee Commission** (1924); **Federal PSC (1937)** under the 1935 Act; **UPSC (1950)**.	**Andhra State PSC (1953)** became the **APPSC on 1 November 1956**; a **Joint PSC** for two or more States can be made by Parliament on their request.

3. Comptroller and Auditor General (Arts 148–151)

- **Who and why:** the CAG is the **head of the audit and accounts** system, the **'guardian of the public purse'**; Dr Ambedkar called it **'the most important officer'** under the Constitution. Appointed by the **President** (warrant); term **6 years or age 65**; removed **like a Supreme Court judge**; salary **charged** on the Consolidated Fund; **not eligible for any further office** under the Government after retirement. First CAG: **V. Narahari Rao**.
- **Work:** audits **all receipts and expenditure** of the **Union and the States** (Art 149; **CAG Duties and Powers Act, 1971**): **compliance**, **propriety** and **performance** audit. **Reports** on Union accounts go to the **President**, who lays them before **Parliament**; State reports go to the **Governor** (Art 151). The **Public Accounts Committee (PAC)** examines them; the CAG is its **'friend, philosopher and guide'** but **not a member**.

4. Other constitutional bodies and offices

Body or office	Article and key facts
Finance Commission	**Art 280**; every **5 years**; chair + 4 members; recommends **tax sharing** and **grants** (Day 15).
Attorney General of India	**Art 76**; **highest law officer**; qualified to be a **Supreme Court judge**; holds office **at the President's pleasure** (no fixed term); can **speak in both Houses** but has **no vote** (**Art 88**); right of audience in **all courts**.
Advocate General	**Art 165**; State's highest law officer, appointed by the **Governor**; qualified to be a **High Court judge**.
Commissions for SCs, STs, BCs	**NCSC: Art 338**; **NCST: Art 338A** (89th Amendment, 2003); **NCBC: Art 338B** (102nd Amendment, 2018); they protect safeguards and report to the President.
Others	**Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities (Art 350B)**; **GST Council (Art 279A)**; **State Election Commission (Art 243K)** and **State Finance Commission (Art 243I)** for local bodies.

EXAM TRAP

EC: Art 324, CEC + 2 ECs, 6 yrs/65, CEC removed like an SC judge, ECs on CEC's advice, 2023 Act (PM, LoP, Cabinet Minister); **Art 325, 326, 329**; **SEC: Art 243K**; **UPSC/SPSC: Arts 315–323**, 6 yrs, 65/62, removal only by the President after SC inquiry (Art 317), Art 320 functions; **APPSC 1 Nov 1956**; **CAG: Arts 148–151**, 6 yrs/65, not a PAC member, 1971 Act; **AG: Art 76, 88**; **Advocate General: Art 165**; **NCSC 338, NCST 338A, NCBC 338B**; **Art 350B**; **Art 279A**; **Art 280**.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the Election Commission of India:
1. It is provided for under Article 324.
2. The Chief Election Commissioner can be removed only in the manner of a Supreme Court judge.
3. An Election Commissioner can be removed by the President on the recommendation of the Chief

Election Commissioner.

4. It conducts elections to panchayats and municipalities.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 2, 3 and 4 only

C. 1, 2 and 3 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: C. Local body elections are conducted by State Election Commissions (Arts 243K, 243ZA).

PRACTICE

Match List-I (Article) with List-II (body):

List-I: A. Article 148 B. Article 280 C. Article 315 D. Article 338

List-II: 1. Finance Commission 2. National Commission for Scheduled Castes 3. Comptroller and Auditor General 4. Public Service Commissions

A. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

B. A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2

C. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Answer: A. 148: CAG; 280: Finance Commission; 315: PSCs; 338: NCSC.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements is NOT correct?

A. Members of the UPSC hold office for six years or until the age of 65.

B. Members of a State Public Service Commission hold office for six years or until the age of 62.

C. A member of a State Public Service Commission can be removed by the Governor.

D. The advice of the Public Service Commissions is not binding on the government.

Answer: C. Though appointed by the Governor, a State PSC member can be removed only by the President (Art 317).

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): The CAG's audit reports on the accounts of the Union are submitted to the President, who causes them to be laid before Parliament.
Reason (R): The CAG is a member of Parliament's Public Accounts Committee.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: C. A is true (Art 151). R is false: the CAG guides the PAC but is not its member.

PRACTICE

An officer is the Government of India's chief legal adviser, holds office at the pleasure of the President, and may speak in either House of Parliament but cannot vote there. Who is this officer?

A. Solicitor General of India

B. Attorney General of India

C. Comptroller and Auditor General

D. Chief Justice of India

Answer: B. Art 76 and Art 88: the Attorney General.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the Election Commission: Articles, composition, appointment, term, removal. 2. Write UPSC and SPSC side by side. 3. Write the CAG, Attorney General and the SC/ST/BC commissions with Articles.

MATHS • Data analysis: tables and bar diagrams

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? Data interpretation (DI) gives you **numbers in a table or chart** and asks questions such as **'by what percent did it rise?'**, **'which is the highest?'** or **'what is the average?'** It tests **careful reading and quick calculation**, not new formulas. Almost every question uses only **four tools**: **percentage change**,

share (percent of total), **average** and **ratio**. The biggest source of mistakes is **misreading** (wrong row, wrong year, wrong units), so **read the title, units and scale first**.

1. The four tools

Tool	Formula	Watch out
% change	(New − Old) ÷ **Old** × 100	Divide by the **earlier (base) value**, never the new one
Share %	Part ÷ **Total** × 100	Find the right **total** (row, column or grand total)
Average	Sum ÷ number of items	Count the items carefully
Ratio	A : B, then **simplify** by the HCF	Keep the **order** asked (A : B, not B : A)

2. Reading a table: worked example

Table 1: Number of students who passed in five colleges

College	2023	2024
P	240	300
Q	180	210
R	320	288
S	150	195
T	210	252
Total	**1,100**	**1,245**

- **% change for P:** (300 − 240) ÷ 240 × 100 = **25%**. For **S**: 45 ÷ 150 = **30%** (the highest). For **R**: (288 − 320) ÷ 320 = **−10%** (the only fall).
- **Average in 2024:** 1,245 ÷ 5 = **249**. **Ratio of totals 2023 : 2024** = 1,100 : 1,245 = **220 : 249**. **Overall rise:** 145 ÷ 1,100 ≈ **13.2%**.
- **Quick trick:** to compare percentage rises without full division, compare **increase ÷ base** as fractions: 45/150 (0.30) is bigger than 60/240 (0.25).

3. Bar diagrams

Type	What it shows
Simple bar	One quantity over years or items (e.g. output each year).
Multiple (grouped) bar	Two or more quantities side by side (e.g. exports and imports each year).
Sub-divided (stacked) bar	A total split into parts in one bar (e.g. a budget by sector).
Percentage bar	Each bar is 100%; parts show shares.

Bar diagram used in questions 4 and 5

- **Reading this chart:** the total over 6 years = 40 + 45 + 50 + 42 + 60 + 66 = **303**, so the average = **50.5** thousand. The **only fall** is 2021 → 2022 (50 → 42, **−16%**); the **biggest rise** is 2022 → 2023 (42 → 60, about **42.9%**); 2024 over 2019 = 26 ÷ 40 = **65%**.
- **Five reading checks:** (1) **title** (what is measured), (2) **units** (thousand, lakh, crore, %), (3) **scale** (does the axis start at 0?), (4) **base year** for % change, (5) the right **total**.

EXAM TRAP

% change = (new − old)/old × 100; **share = part/total × 100**; **average = sum/count**; **ratio, simplified**; **read title, units, scale first**; **compare fractions instead of dividing fully**; **four bar types**: simple, multiple, sub-divided, percentage.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

(Table 1) By what percentage did the number of students who passed in college P increase from 2023 to 2024?

A. 20%

B. 25%

C. 60%

D. 30%

Answer: B. (300 − 240)/240 × 100 = 25%.

PRACTICE

(Table 1) What is the average number of students who passed per college in 2024?

A. 245

B. 252

C. 249

D. 255

Answer: C. 1,245 ÷ 5 = 249.

PRACTICE

(Table 1) Consider the following statements:

1. Only college R showed a fall from 2023 to 2024.

2. College S had the highest percentage increase.

3. The total number who passed rose by more than 15%.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only

B. 2 and 3 only

C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A. R fell 10%; S rose 30% (highest); the total rose 145/1,100 ≈ 13.2%, less than 15%.

PRACTICE

(Bar diagram) By about what percentage did output rise from 2022 to 2023?

A. 18%

B. 30%

C. 42.9%

D. 50%

Answer: C. (60 − 42)/42 × 100 ≈ 42.9%.

PRACTICE

(Bar diagram) In how many of the six years was the output above the six-year average?

A. 2

B. 3

C. 4

D. 1

Answer: A. Average = 303/6 = 50.5; only 2023 (60) and 2024 (66) are above it (2021 is 50).

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the four tools with formulas. 2. Redo the Table 1 calculations without looking. 3. Write the four bar types and the five reading checks.

NOTEBOOK PAGE · Day 16: write this from memory

Close the notes. Write these headings, fill every blank, then correct in a different colour.

HISTORY: Revolt of 1857

Area	Write
Causes	Political, economic, social-religious, military, immediate (Enfield rifle)
Course	Barrackpore 29 Mar, Meerut 10 May, Delhi 11 May 1857; Delhi retaken Sept 1857; peace July 1858
Centres	Leader and British officer for Delhi, Kanpur, Lucknow, Jhansi, Bihar; Hyderabad Residency 1857
Failure, nature, results	Five reasons for failure; views (Savarkar, Majumdar, Sen, Seeley); 1858 Act, Proclamation, army changes

POLITY: Constitutional bodies

- For each body write: Article, who appoints, term, removal, functions, one fact: Election Commission, SEC, UPSC, SPSC (APPSC), CAG, Finance Commission, Attorney General, Advocate General, NCSC, NCST, NCBC, GST Council.

MATHS: Tables and bar diagrams

Write: % change = (new − old)/old × 100; share % = part/total × 100; average; ratio; four kinds of bar diagram; the five reading checks (title, units, scale, base year, total).